
Teambuilding

In this section, you find tips and tools for setting up a transdisciplinary team. You learn what a transdisciplinary team is, how to assemble such a team, and how to ensure effective collaboration around a complex problem.

'Community building', or group formation, is essential in two aspects of transdisciplinary collaboration: within your project group, and external towards as many relevant stakeholders as possible. Note: this process takes time and is easier said than done.

1. 1. Let's start within your own group. It is important to take the time to get to know each other well to create a foundation where there is a sense of community. From this foundation, differences between the diverse team members can be bridged in order to really collaborate towards innovative knowledge. Good mutual relationships give all involved stakeholders energy, allowing the project to run at full capacity.

This may sound obvious, but in practice, teams mostly don't put enough time and effort in teambuilding. Make a conscious effort to make this time and don't be tempted by the rush to move 'forward' with the project. After all: it is hard to build high towers without a solid foundation.

2. 2. It's also important to actively network and build relationships with the 'field' around your topic or problem. This helps you to better understand the challenge and gather various perspectives. Through nurturing relationships with relevant stakeholders from the beginning on, you have easier access to ideas and people who can help when your team gets stuck later on. Expanding your network also helps you finding the right additional people to join the project team. Sometimes, you may not even know that you needed those people in advance, for example because when they represent perspectives you were not yet familiar with (Tilma et al., 2023).

In transdisciplinary collaboration, you should always stay alert on potential participants with perspectives that are missing around the table. It is up to you and your team to

decide how to involve these stakeholders in the project: as advisors, sparring partners, local guides, or researchers.